



Inspection Report

New Mexico State University
Research MSC 3RES
PO Box 30001
LAS CRUCES, NM 88003

Customer ID: **1073**

Certificate: **85-R-0009**

Site: 001

NEW MEXICO STATE
UNIVERSITY

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION

Date: 17-MAR-2026

2.33(b)(3)

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care.

The facility failed to communicate with the attending veterinarian in a timely manner concerning an adverse event involving the health and well-being of animals. Despite regular maintenance of the HVAC system in the bat housing area, the system failed to obey the thermostat settings on 01/03/2026, leading to overheating in bat holding rooms. This temperature excursion impacted most of the bats in the colony and resulted in the deaths of 2 female and 2 male adult Seba's short-tailed bats and one adult male Jamaican fruit bat. Facility records and IACUC minutes document that husbandry and laboratory staff responded immediately to mitigate the problem when they discovered the issue during daily observations: They quickly relocated the surviving bats from the affected rooms, assessed their health and well-being, and provided them with additional water and food to help minimize the impact of the excessive heat. The animal facility manager and other staff were notified promptly; however, no one notified the attending veterinarian about the event for several days. Once notified, the veterinarian agreed with the actions taken by the staff following the incident. The facility is in the process of revising the current Contingency Plan and other documents to better emphasize timely reporting of animal impacts to the attending veterinarian and re-training all applicable staff accordingly.

Although the attending veterinarian was finally made aware and went to the facility to evaluate the animals many days after the event, the facility's failure to relay the incident details to her in a timely manner prevented the veterinarian from participating in the real-time decisions made and actions taken to help the surviving animals. The registrant must not only ensure that animals are observed at least daily to assess their health and well-being, but also establish and maintain a mechanism of frequent and direct communication so that timely and accurate information on problems of animal health, behavior and well-being is conveyed to the attending veterinarian.

TO BE CORRECTED BY 04/01/2026

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with facility representatives.

Prepared By: TAMILA STOTT

USDA, APHIS, Animal Care

Date:

24-MAR-2026

Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

Received by Title: Facility Representative

Date:

24-MAR-2026



Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
1073	85-R-0009	001	NEW MEXICO STATE UNIVERSITY	17-MAR-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000001	<i>Antrozous pallidus</i>	PALLID BAT
000040	<i>Artibeus jamaicensis</i>	JAMAICAN FRUIT-EATING BAT / JAMAICAN FRUIT BAT
000000	<i>Carollia perspicillata</i>	SEBA'S SHORT-TAILED BAT
000041	Total	